

DAN XU

xu.dan@rutgers.edu • +1 (818) 573-0510 • github.com/danxudanxu

EDUCATION

Rutgers University, School of Arts and Sciences

Ph.D. in Economics, expected May 2031

M.A. in Economics, May 2026

Fields: Macro-Finance, Financial Econometrics

University of Southern California, Dornsife College of Letters, Arts and Sciences

M.S. in Applied Economics and Econometrics, May 2025

Brown University, Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs

Master of Public Affairs, May 2021

Boston University, College of Arts and Sciences

B.A., Economics and International Relations (double major), June 2020

WORKING PAPERS

"Learning to Price Political Risk: Stock Market Volatility Responses to U.S.-China Trade Policy Shocks"
(Working Paper)

- High-frequency event study of equity market responses to 44 U.S.-China trade policy announcements across two Trump administrations (2018–2026)
- Combines NYSE TAQ Millisecond data for U.S. ETFs with RESSET high-frequency data for Chinese ETFs; constructs realized volatility and cross-market spillover measures using non-overlapping trading hours
- Theoretical anchor: Pastor and Veronesi (2012), Kozłowski, Veldkamp, and Venkateswaran (2020); identifies asymmetric belief revision across markets
- Headline findings: U.S. intraday abnormal returns approximately 3× larger in Term 2 (1.15% vs. 0.39% in 2-hour window); Chinese markets show attenuation; cross-market difference-in-differences of 1.95 percentage points at event-day level

"Pushing on a String through the ZLB Decade: A Tenreyro–Thwaites (2016) Replication and Post-GFC Extension" (Working Paper, May 2026)

- Replication and 17-year post-GFC extension of Tenreyro and Thwaites (2016, AEJ:Macro), spanning 1969Q1–2019Q4
- Smooth-transition state-dependent local projections with Romer–Romer narrative shocks merged with Acosta (2019) extension; cumulative-LP specification following Barnichon and Brownlees (2019) and Montiel Olea and Plagborg-Møller (2021)
- FFR asymmetry rejects symmetric transmission at the 1% level in both samples ($p = 0.006$); real-side effects do not tighten with extended data
- Andrews (1993) sup-Wald break test at GFC candidate dates; ZLB mechanism decomposition splitting recession-regime response into pre-ZLB and ZLB components

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Supervised Research, University of Southern California

Supervisor: Prof. Steve Sapra (former Executive Vice President, PIMCO)

December 2024– May 2025

- Conducted original research on U.S.-China trade policy and equity market responses across two Trump administrations; project evolved into current working paper
- Rescoped from daily-frequency to intraday methodology following supervisory feedback; redesigned event identification, abnormal return estimation, and volatility spillover analysis

Research Assistant, Tsinghua University, School of Economics and Management

- Contributed to development of Xinhua 08 Financial Information Platform and its currency exchange algorithm
- Developed ARIMA, GARCH, and VAR models forecasting exchange rate dynamics between CNY and ASEAN currencies (VND, IDR, MMK), with policy analysis of Belt and Road economic integration effects
- Examined cross-border CNY payment and settlement system; identified inefficiencies in regional currency pairs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Allianz China, Guangdong Branch

Senior Business Development Director & Personal Finance Advisor

December 2021 – August 2023

- Led a wealth management team of three serving over 30 domestic and international clients; managed client portfolios and generated monthly performance reports
- Personally managed over ¥20 million CNY (approximately \$3 million USD) in client assets across trusts and insurance products; provided research-based portfolio recommendations
- Authored monthly market analyses integrating macroeconomic and international relations perspectives; drove direct client acquisition

Rhode Island Public Expenditure Council (RIPEC)

Policy Analyst Intern

January 2021 – June 2021

- Conducted cost-benefit analysis of Rhode Island's "Rebuild RI" economic incentive program (\$20 million annual budget); evaluated over 40 projects on job creation and economic output
- Coauthored policy report selected as exemplary by program leadership for use with subsequent consultancy cohorts
- Recommendations contributed to revised program targeting and evaluation metrics

TECHNICAL SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Programming: Python, R, MATLAB, Stata

Econometrics: Time series (VAR, GARCH, HAR-RV, local projections, state-dependent LP), high-frequency event studies, Barndorff-Nielsen–Shephard jump tests, permutation inference, structural break tests, Newey–West HAC estimation; Dynare for DSGE solution

Data Sources: WRDS (NYSE TAQ Millisecond), FRED, RESSET High Frequency, Bloomberg

Comparative Political Economy: Chinese economic governance (Five-Year Plans, State Council policy, SOE reform, financial regulators, anti-corruption campaigns); China's outward strategy (Belt and Road, outward direct investment); U.S. fiscal and tariff policy history; political risk pricing and cross-border financial transmission

LANGUAGES

Mandarin (native), Cantonese (native), English (near-native)

REFERENCES

Laurence J. Kotlikoff

William Fairfield Warren Professor of Economics, Boston University

kotlikof@bu.edu

Michael DiBiase

President and CEO, Rhode Island Public Expenditure Council (RIPEC)

m_dibiase@ripec.com